

CANVAS CLASH

Future & Conceptual Design • Industrial & Spatial Design

THE CONCEPT

Canvas Clash is a live, zero-day design challenge. The actual design brief is revealed on the day, and participants must develop, communicate and present a design response under time pressure using their personal digital design tools.

CATEGORY 01 • JUNIOR

FUTURE & CONCEPTUAL DESIGN

GRADES 6–8 • HUMAN ONLY

Future-facing concepts and possibilities. Design thinking, visual communication and originality take centre stage.

CATEGORY 02 • SENIOR

INDUSTRIAL & SPATIAL DESIGN

GRADES 9–10 • AI PERMITTED

Physical products, environments and spatial solutions shaped around emerging technology and real-world constraints.

WHAT TO BRING

DEVICE COMPULSORY

Bring a charged personal laptop or tablet.

DIGITAL DESIGN

Use your preferred digital design software and workflow.

ZERO-DAY

The actual brief drops live on the event day.

AI RULE

Junior: Human Only. Senior: AI Permitted + prompt log.

THE DROP → THE DESIGN SPRINT → THE PITCH

The examples on the following pages illustrate the challenge style only. The actual problems are revealed on the day.

FUTURE & CONCEPTUAL DESIGN

HUMAN ONLY • AI NOT PERMITTED

Sample challenge briefs demonstrate the style and difficulty of the Junior category. They are NOT the actual competition questions.

01 THE FUTURE SCHOOL UNIFORM

School uniforms are designed mainly around appearance and identity, but students experience changing weather, different activities and long school days. Future schools may require clothing that is more adaptable without losing the sense of belonging created by a common uniform. Design a future school uniform that can adapt to different activities and conditions while remaining recognisable as a school uniform.

02 ZERO-WASTE FASHION

The production of clothing can create significant amounts of unused fabric and discarded material. Future designers may need to rethink how garments are constructed so that less material is wasted during production and use. Design a fashionable garment that uses an innovative approach to minimise material waste while maintaining an appealing and functional appearance.

03 THE FILTER BECOMES REAL

Digital filters allow people to change their appearance instantly by adding unusual colours, textures, shapes and visual effects. As digital and physical experiences become increasingly connected, fashion could begin incorporating ideas that previously existed only on screens. Design a physical fashion item inspired by an imaginary social-media filter that makes a digital visual effect possible in the real world.

INDUSTRIAL & SPATIAL DESIGN

AI PERMITTED • PROMPT LOG REQUIRED

Sample challenge briefs demonstrate the style and difficulty of the Senior category. They are NOT the actual competition questions.

01 DIGITAL FASHION BRIDGE

Digital fashion allows users to experiment with appearances that may be impossible or impractical to reproduce physically. As digital identities increasingly influence real-world identity, the boundary between virtual and physical fashion is becoming less distinct. Design a physical fashion product that connects a person's digital appearance with their real-world clothing while remaining functional and commercially realistic.

02 THE VIRAL POP-UP STORE

Social-media trends can cause sudden spikes in demand for particular products, forcing brands to create temporary retail experiences quickly. Conventional stores are expensive and difficult to reconfigure when a trend changes. Design a modular pop-up retail environment that can be rapidly assembled, reconfigured and transported while creating a visually engaging experience suitable for both physical visitors and social-media content.

03 THE CREATOR MICRO-STUDIO

Social-media creators increasingly produce professional-looking photographs, short-form videos, livestreams and podcasts from homes or other small spaces. Traditional studios require significant space and equipment, making them inaccessible to many creators. Design a compact creator studio that can transform between filming, photography, livestreaming and editing modes while providing efficient storage, lighting and equipment management.

THE ZERO-DAY

THE EXAMPLES ARE NOT THE QUESTIONS YOU WILL RECEIVE.

01 THE DROP

The actual Canvas Clash brief is revealed live on the event day.

02 THE DESIGN SPRINT

Research, ideate, sketch, model, refine and present a complete design response under the event's time limit.

03 DIGITAL DESIGN

Laptops or tablets are the design medium. The outcome may be a physical product, object, environment, space, structure or other design concept.

04 THE PITCH

Present the design clearly, explain the problem it solves and defend the decisions behind the final concept.

05 AI POLICY

Junior: Human Only. Senior: AI Permitted. Senior participants must maintain and submit an AI prompt log where AI is used.

CORE IDEA

Canvas Clash is about solving a future-facing design problem—not about making something merely look futuristic. Strong responses connect technology, people, space and real-world constraints.